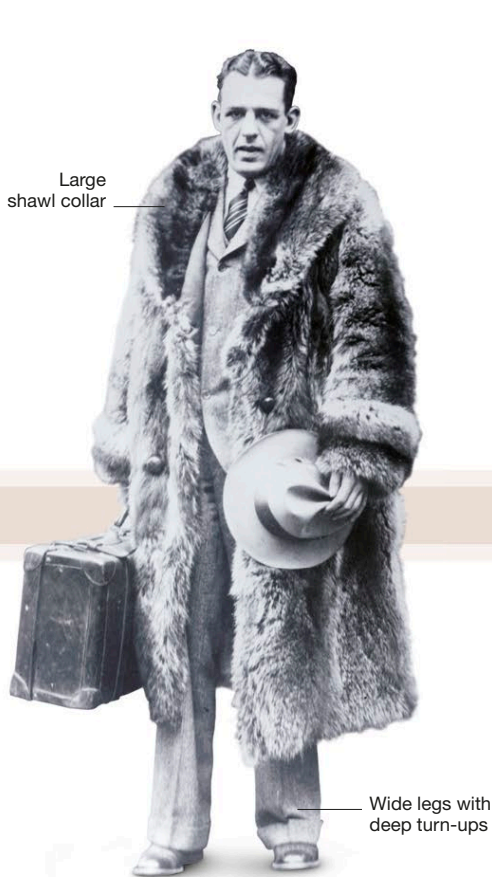


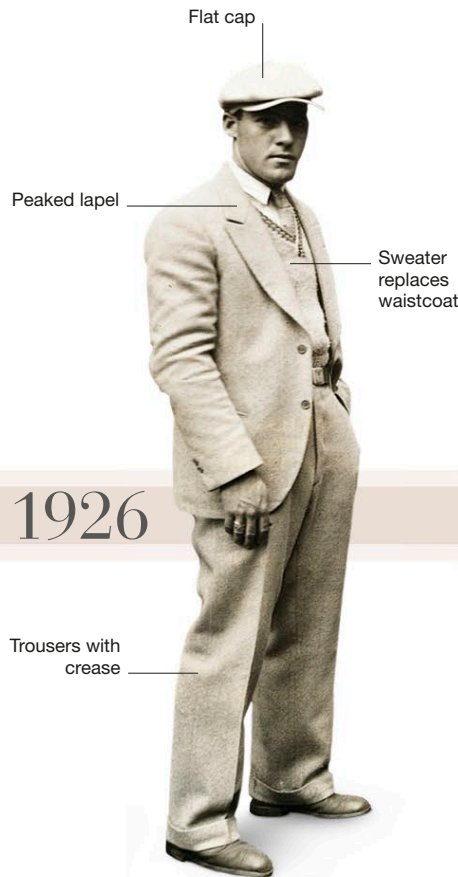
1920–1929

SUITS FOR ALL

In 1922 one fashion critic declared that the lounge suit had become “the almost universal utility dress for men”, but this did not mean that sartorial distinctions had become extinct. Differences in the quality as well as the quantity of suits a man owned remained. A suit could be bought ready-to-wear or second-hand, but many men still “bespoke” a suit from their tailor or had it made to measure. Many appreciated the English cut promoted by London’s Savile Row tailors, but others preferred the less fitted and softer American “sack suit”, or the more overtly fashionable shapes provided by the French *tailleur*. Suit fabrics became lighter, particularly for summer – as demonstrated by the cloth used to make “Palm Beach” suits in the US. This affected male underwear and slowly vests worn with cotton shorts replaced the earlier “union suit” (all-in-one undergarment). Towards 1930 the high-waisted suits of the early part of the decade made way for a straighter silhouette.

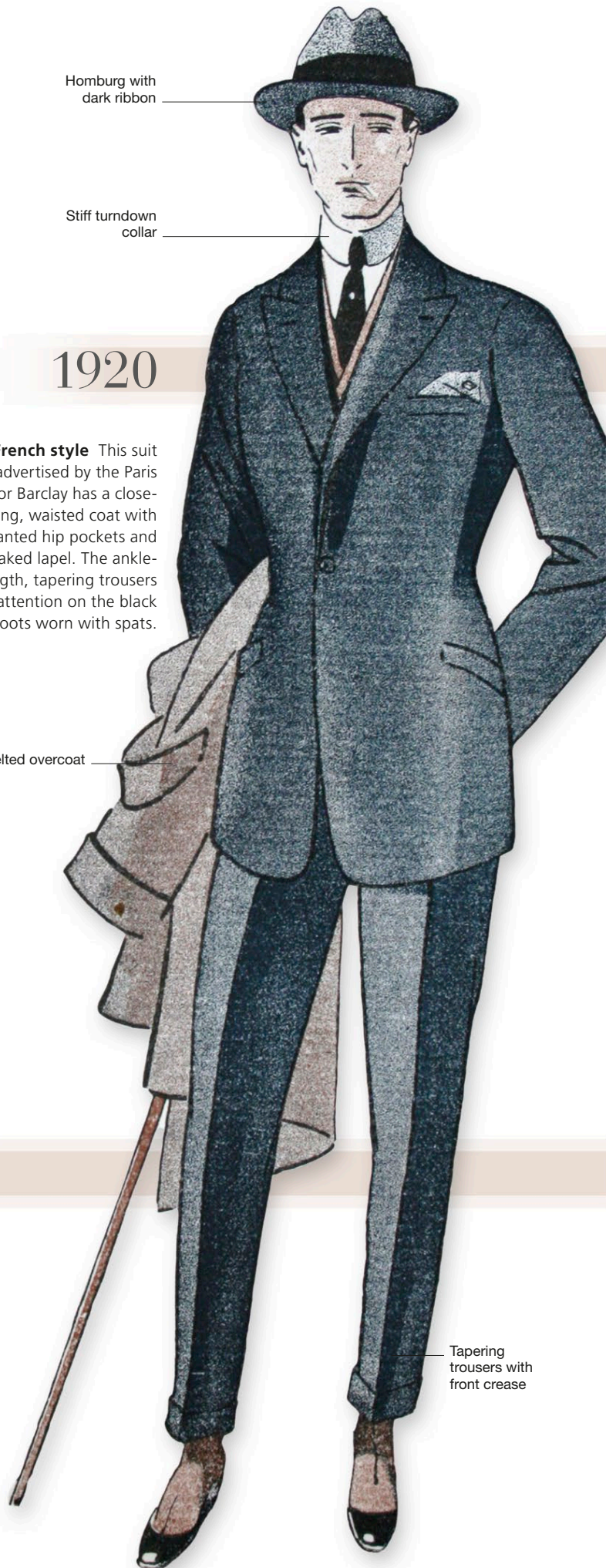


Raccoon The American football idol Harold “Red” Grange wears a comfortable-looking tweed suit with a three-button jacket. Coats made of the fur of the North American raccoon were hardwearing and recommended for driving.



1926

Casual “Red” Grange wears a low-cut American sack suit with little or no shaping around the waist and natural shoulders. The sportsman’s V-neck sweater, tucked into his belted trousers, and flat cap denote informality.



1920

French style This suit advertised by the Paris tailor Barclay has a close-fitting, waisted coat with slanted hip pockets and peaked lapel. The ankle-length, tapering trousers focus attention on the black boots worn with spats.